The Great Invincible Knowledge Mantra

Mahāvidyā Aparājita · Toh 978 · Derge Kangyur
གཞན་གསྱི་མ་ཐུབ་པའ་རིག་པ་ཆན་མ།

The Great Knowledge Mantra That Cannot Be Overcome by Others, known in Sanskrit as Mahāvidyā Aparājita and in Tibetan as Gzhan gyis mi thub pa'i rig pa chen mo, is a brief protective text centered on a dhāraṇī, or incantation, of invincibility. After paying homage to the Buddha and to the seven buddhas of the past together with their communities of disciples, it invokes the distinctive virtues of each of them: the splendor of Vipaśyin, the miraculous power of Śikhin, the wisdom of Viśvabhū, the strength of Krakucchanda, the training of Kanakamuni, the qualities of Kāśyapa, and the diligence of Śākyamuni, praying that through these the reciter may always be happy. It then gives a short mantra of victory that calls upon the one who is unconquered and who crushes hostile armies, so the recitation is meant to bring protection from enemies and fears. The work is Toh 978 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts gathered among the canon's collections of incantations and protective spells.

In the language of India: mahā bidyā aparājita. In the language of Tibet: The Great Knowledge Mantra That Cannot Be Overcome by Others.

Homage to the Buddha.
Homage to the seven perfectly complete buddhas together with their Saṅgha of śrāvakas.

Those who have crossed beyond all enemies and fears:
The great splendor of Vipaśyin,
Śikhin, whose very nature is miraculous power,
The wisdom of Viśvabhū,
The very strength of Krakucchanda,
The training of Kanakamuni,
The qualities of Kāśyapa,
And the diligence of Śākyamuni:
Through these, may I always be happy.

tadyathā jayanti bijayanti jaye bijaye jiti jite aparājiti barsainyapramardhaniye svāhā

The Great Knowledge Mantra That Cannot Be Overcome by Others is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The verse names the seven buddhas of the past in their traditional order. The Tibetan uses lit. "Dispeller of Wrong Faith" (log dad sel ba) where Krakucchanda's name belongs in that sequence. It is a known alternative Tibetan rendering of his name, although his usual Tibetan name is 'khor ba 'jig. "Śikhin" renders gtsug tor, "crown protuberance," a standard short form of his name. In the first line of the verse it is unclear whether "crossed beyond all enemies and fears" describes all seven buddhas or Vipaśyin alone.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.